

Interview 1

1. Think about the last time you had a question about a university policy, rule, deadline, or process. What was the question?
 - How do you pay parking tickets?
2. How did you try to find the answer?
 - Google search, then My PNW website, then finally ended up on PNW rules page.
3. What did you try first?
 - Google
4. Were you able to find the answer? What was difficult or frustrating?
 - No, did not find answer, it was very difficult and frustrating.
5. Did you ever find multiple answers or information that seemed inconsistent or outdated? What did you do?
 - Little or no information was found, searched Google
6. Is there anything else about finding university information that is frustrating or confusing that we haven't talked about?
 - The school has multiple campuses, finding relevant information about a specific campus proved difficult. Current chatbot "Leo" just provides links, not much more.

Interview 2

1. Think about the last time you had a question about a university policy, rule, deadline, or process. What was the question?
 - Does PNW offer a computer science PHD program?
2. How did you try to find the answer?
 - PNW website

3. What did you try first? Why?
 - Searched school website for program information because I figured I could easily find an answer.
4. Were you able to find the answer? What was difficult or frustrating?
 - No, I did not find the answer, it was difficult because search results didn't answer my direct question, I ended up just asking my advisor.
5. Did you ever find multiple answers or information that seemed inconsistent or outdated? What did you do?
 - I did not see the information I needed at all
6. Is there anything else about finding university information that is frustrating or confusing that we haven't talked about?
 - Navigating the different colleges, (e.g. College of Engineering and Science, or College of Technology), and finding details about the programs offered at each college can be a bit confusing.

Interview 3

1. Think about the last time you had a question about a university policy, rule, deadline, or process. What was the question?
 - Question about an error I received while registering for classes. How do I fix this error (included error message)?
2. How did you try to find the answer?
 - PNW website.
3. What did you try first?
 - Web searching
4. Were you able to find the answer? What was difficult or frustrating?

- Yes, through advisor. Search results only returned links to pages which did not have an answer to my question.
5. Did you ever find multiple answers or information that seemed inconsistent or outdated? What did you do?
 - Didn't find much at all
 6. Is there anything else about finding university information that is frustrating or confusing that we haven't talked about?
 - Finding solutions to personalized issues is always very difficult.

1. Think about the last time you had a question about a university policy, rule, deadline, or process. What was the question?

Ans:

Last time I had a question about a university process, I wanted to know how to submit my plan of study for my master's in computer science at Purdue University Northwest. I was unsure about which courses I needed to include, whether I needed approval from my advisor, and when I had to submit the plan.

2. How did you try to find the answer?

Ans:

I first checked the Purdue University Northwest website and looked for information about graduate student requirements and the plan of study. I also checked my student portal to see whether there were any instructions or forms available.

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3. What did you try first? Why?

Ans:

I tried searching the university website first because it is the official source of information. I thought I could find the required courses, submission instructions, and deadlines there without needing to contact anyone.

4. Were you able to find the answer? What was difficult or frustrating?

Ans:

I was able to find some info, but it was difficult to understand exactly which courses I need to select for my master's in CS. I was also unsure about the approval process and whether I needed to submit the plan myself or wait for my academic advisor.

5. Did you ever find multiple answers or info that seemed inconsistent or outdated? What did you do?

Ans:

I sometimes found info on different university pages that was difficult to compare or understand. When this happened, I checked the most recent info available and contacted my academic advisor to confirm the correct requirements before submitting anything.

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6. Is there anything else about finding university info that is frustrating or confusing that we haven't talked about?

Ans:

One frustrating part is that important info is sometimes spread across different university websites and departments. It would be helpful to have one central platform where students could easily find updated info about courses, graduation requirements, deadlines, and university procedures.

Question7: What would make it easier for you to find university information?

Ans: I would like to have one centralized platform where students can search for university policies, deadlines, course requirements, registration information, and graduation procedures. The platform should provide simple explanations, updated information, and links to official university sources.

Question8: Would you use a university chatbot to answer your questions?

Ans: Yes, I would use a university chatbot if it provided accurate and updated information. It could help students quickly find answers without searching through multiple webpages. I would also want it to provide links to official sources and direct me to the appropriate department when it cannot answer a question.

Question9: What is the biggest pain point in your current process?

Ans: The biggest pain point is that finding university information can take a lot of time, especially when the information is spread across different websites. I sometimes have to search multiple times or contact different departments to get a clear answer. Having one reliable and easy-to-use platform would make the process much easier.

Question10: What do you do when you find different or outdated information?

Ans: I compare the information from different university webpages and check the latest university emails or announcements. If I am still unsure, I contact my academic advisor or the appropriate department to confirm the correct information before making a decision.

Question11: How long does it usually take you to find an answer?

Ans: It depends on the question. Simple questions may take only a few minutes, but more complicated questions involving registration, academic requirements, or university policies can take much longer. Sometimes I need to check several sources or wait for a response from the university staff.

Question 1: When you have a question about PNW, where do you usually look first?

Answer:

I usually check the PNW website or my student portal first. If I can't find the information there, I usually ask my classmates or contact a professor or the appropriate department.

Question 2: Is it easy to find the information you are looking for?

Answer:

Not always. Sometimes I can find it quickly, but other times I have to check different pages before I find the information I need.

Question 3: Have you ever had to spend a lot of time trying to find an answer?

Answer:

Yes. Sometimes I have to search through different webpages, and if I still can't find the answer, I have to email someone and wait for a response.

Question 4: What do you think would make this process easier?

Answer:

I think having one place where students can ask university-related questions and get clear answers would make it much easier.

Interview 2

Question 1: When you have a question about PNW, where do you usually look first?

Answer:

I usually search on the PNW website first. If I can't find the information, I ask my classmates, professor, advisor, or the university department related to my question.

Question 2: Is it easy to find the information you are looking for?

Answer:

Sometimes it is easy, but sometimes it is difficult to find the exact information I need. I may have to look through several pages to find the right information.

Question 3: Have you ever had to spend a lot of time trying to find an answer?

Answer:

Yes, sometimes. If the information is not available on the website, I may have to contact someone by email and wait for their response.

Question 4: What do you think would make this process easier?

Answer:

It would be helpful to have one place where students can ask questions and get quick and clear answers instead of searching through different pages.

Main Pain Points Identified

Based on both interviews, we found the following problems:

- * It can be difficult to find specific information on the PNW website.**
- * Students sometimes have to check multiple webpages.**
- * It is not always clear which department to contact.**
- * Finding an answer can take time.**
- * Students may have to wait for an email response.**
- * Asking classmates or other people is sometimes necessary when the information is difficult to find.**

Conclusion

Both interviews showed that students mainly use the PNW website, student portal, professors, advisors, university departments, and classmates to get answers to university-related questions. A centralized place for students to ask questions and receive clear information could make the process faster and easier.

When was the last time you had a question about a university process?

Looking at the graduation application, Had to Look at my pnw then Looked at the email, or message the advisor.

were you able to find the answers?

it was a little annoying to find the answers, it wasn't too bad though.

how were you able to figure it out?

the email linked to the website which linked to a website that lead to PNW, multiple steps that lead to the right spot.

did you ever find multiple answers?

there is not a lot of conflicting stuff they are hidden under multiple links. they had to bookmark some of the web browsers. A lot of answers were also outdated.

is there anything frustrating they haven't talked about?

The Tasks in my PNW does not always update correctly.

Was there outdated information?

There does seem to be outdated information that was covered as correct information. Hiding the proper solution needed.

What is your experience with course applications?

For the most part they ask their advisor, however this was sometimes difficult especially since they consistently had new advisors. Requires a pin for the scheduling that is inconsistent.

Outside the advisor is it hard to find information of what you need?

It isn't too hard to find stuff without the advisor. It could use a graph of the pre-requisites record for a class.

Is it hard to find the pre-requisites?

You need to look multiple classes deep to find your courses. Finding information about a class can be very problematic.

People are taking an extra semester do you think that is a scheduling mishap?

There has been issues where the information given has been incorrect, they have been given false information about the courses needed to graduate. They were un-aware that this course was required.

Is the chatbot supposed to be basic information or to help scheduling?

It should probably just support general information, but future scenarios. Changing the room can happen suddenly.